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NOT A RASH RETURN TO ENGLAND

AP

Marcus Rashford ticked **all the right boxes** for his new club, Barcelona, netting a brace away against Newcastle United in the Champions League.

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Life, more often than not, gives you a second chance. For Marcus Rashford (**above, front**), it is certainly the case now. The England forward fell out with Manchester United manager Ruben Amorim last season and was loaned to Aston Villa, transitioning from United's blue-eyed boy to the one who cried foul.

But at Barcelona, his new club on loan from United, he looks to be finding his rhythm as he scored twice on his return to England for the UEFA Champions League (UCL) clash against Newcastle United.

In that game, pitching in for injured Lamine Yamal, Rashford ranked first or joint-first for shots (6), touches in the opposition box (10), dribbles (5), and possession won (6) for Barcelona, becoming the first player at the club with such numbers in a UCL match since Lionel Messi in 2015.

By contrast, Kevin de Bruyne's return to England had a different tale to tell, with the Belgian leaving Manchester City this summer on a free transfer as one of its most successful players.

Leading Napoli's engine room this time around, De Bruyne's side fell 0-2 to Guardiola's men, and to add insult to injury, the Serie A

side was reduced to 10 men when Giovanni di Lorenzo was sent off within the first 22 minutes.

Real Madrid, another side that saw one of its wards — Dani Carvajal — sent off, rode on a brace from Kylian Mbappe to sail past Marseille.

Atletico Madrid almost haunted Liverpool with the ghosts of the 2020 UCL elimination with Marcos Llorente, as in the round of 16 match then, scoring a brace. However, Virgil van Dijk's injury-time strike saw the Reds rule the roost.

Defending champion Paris Saint-Germain shrugged off worries about consistency with a commanding 4-0 victory over Atalanta, while Lloyd Kelly's stoppage-time equaliser helped Juventus salvage a 4-4 draw against the 2024 UCL runner-up Borussia Dortmund.